

called about a deal “too good to pass up.” He had called only because his wife pressured him into it. “But we have to see you right away,” he said. “I’ve got to move on this quickly.” So I scheduled the time to see them the next day.

It seems that Chad had a friend who knew a really hotshot computer specialist in Colorado who had developed a program to do stock market trades between the U.S. and European stock exchanges and make profits on the differences.

He was taking in investors and making over 10 percent per month for them. Chad had already cashed in his retirement plan and was about to borrow against the equity in their home. He calculated that he could make enough to start his own business within a couple of years.

His wife, Chris, was panicked to think that he was about to risk \$25,000 with someone he didn’t even know. Chad said he had talked with several other investors who were making lots of money. He said the developer had paid exactly what he promised every month.

My question was, “Why does he need your money if he’s able to make over 100 percent per year? Why doesn’t he just borrow the money at 10 percent?”

Chad answered, “He wants Christian investors so that he can get into other ventures in the future.” By experience I have found that any investment targeted primarily at Christians is worthy of some suspicion. So I asked Chad if he would mind if I checked this person out.

“No,” he replied, but then asked how long it would take because he had to make a decision quickly or the opportunity would be closed. I shared the biblical principles of get-rich-quick with Chad, but it fell on deaf ears. His decision was made. I was just a necessary step to pacify his wife.

In my investigations, I could find nothing on this computer trading genius. If he had learned his trade by handling stocks and bonds, nobody knew about it. I called to get a financial statement and was assured several times that one was “on the way.” I could never get even the slightest documentation on what he was doing.